

C2-01 Advanced Excel & Power Query - Start Here

Begin here before AX1

WHY THIS MODULE EXISTS

C2-01 turns spreadsheet skill into a controlled, repeatable analyst workflow. You will not be rewarded for the longest formula. You will be rewarded for visible rules, clean keys, predictable grain, refreshable transformations and evidence that proves the output is safe.

EXACT ROUTE

AX1 Teaching Book → matching workbook sheet → save genuine attempt → validate → explain → protected review → changed retry. Repeat AX1–AX10. Then Mini-Lab month-end refresh → Gate A. Weak competency routes to targeted repair. Gate B/C remain protected unless a fresh full reassessment is explicitly assigned.

RUNTIME CHECK

Before AX2/AX3, confirm your Excel supports XLOOKUP/dynamic arrays. Before AX6, confirm Power Query opens in Excel for Windows. If a runtime feature is unavailable, record it as an environment issue rather than pretending the lesson passed.

C2-01 tools and prerequisite check

Do not confuse environment failure with learner failure

YOU SHOULD ALREADY KNOW

Basic formulas, Tables, simple lookups, filters, PivotTable basics and basic data cleaning. C2-00 concepts—metric definition, grain and validation—should be understandable if you chose the C2A route.

YOU NEED

Preferred: current Excel on Windows. Power Query Desktop for AX6–AX10. Practice CSV folder. No Fabric/cloud tenant required. External videos are support, not completion dependencies.

COMPATIBILITY RECOVERY

If XLOOKUP is unavailable, practice the same exact-match/key-quality contract with INDEX/MATCH and mark XLOOKUP runtime verification pending. If FILTER/UNIQUE/SORT are unavailable, do not simulate mastery with screenshots. If Power Query is missing, repair the Excel installation/runtime before AX6 or use an available supported lab machine.

C2-01 mastery / Gate contract

No percentage gaming

LESSON PASS

Fresh independent build + source/key/grain prediction + validation/reconciliation + explain-back + changed retry. A working formula/query without these controls is Developing, not Mastered.

GATE A

First independent integrated test. You must control file scope, formula/query logic, key quality, refresh and release evidence.

B/C RETEST

Fresh domains/datasets. Repair never reveals the next full Gate automatically. Critical source/key/grain/reconciliation failure blocks pass.